Strings in Python

BEGINNER LESSON | Qspiders | Python 3

Learning goals: Create text, read its first character, and check its type.

1. What is a string?

A string is a sequence of characters used to store text. Put text inside matching single or double quotes. Python calls this type `str`.

2. Create and use

An index is a character's position. Indexing starts at `0`, so `word[0]` reads the first character.

```
word = "Python"
print(word)     # Output: Python
print(word[0])  # Output: P
```

3. Check the type

Use `type()` to find a value's data type.

```
print(type(word))  # Output: <class 'str'>
```

4. Key points

- `"Hello"` and `'Hello'` are both strings.
- `"123"` is text, even though it contains digits.
- Strings keep their characters in order.
- You cannot replace one character inside an existing string. You can assign a new string to the variable.

5. Try it yourself

Store your name in `name`. Print the name and its first character.